

Lecture 12

Krylov-subspace solvers:

spectral polynomials, Arnoldi algorithm
polynomial approximation problem, GMRES,
preconditioning

Krylov Subspace Methods

Krylov subspace

The k -dimensional Krylov subspace $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$ of the linear system

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$$

is defined as the space spanned by the sequence of Krylov vectors $\{\mathbf{b}, A\mathbf{b}, A^2\mathbf{b}, \dots, A^{k-1}\mathbf{b}\}$:

$$\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b}) = \text{span} \{\mathbf{b}, A\mathbf{b}, A^2\mathbf{b}, \dots, A^{k-1}\mathbf{b}\}$$

Krylov subspace and simple iterations

The *residual* vector $\mathbf{r}_k$ is defined as

$$\mathbf{r}_k = \mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k$$

One can formulate a simple iterative scheme for $\mathbf{r}_k$:

$$\mathbf{r}_{k+1} = (I - A)\mathbf{r}_k$$

Which is equivalent to the simple iteration for $\mathbf{x}_k$ with $H = I - A$ and $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{b}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_{k+1} &= (I - A)(\mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k) = \mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k - A\mathbf{b} + A^2\mathbf{x}_k \\ -A\mathbf{x}_{k+1} &= -A\mathbf{x}_k - A\mathbf{b} + A^2\mathbf{x}_k \\ \mathbf{x}_{k+1} &= (I - A)\mathbf{x}_k + \mathbf{b}\end{aligned}$$

As we know, this scheme will converge iff $\rho(I - A) < 1$. We see, though, that both $\mathbf{r}_k \in \mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{r}_0)$ and $\mathbf{x}_k - \mathbf{x}_0 \in \mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{r}_0)$.

Spectral polynomials of simple iterations

Let there be $A = V\Lambda V^{-1}$ with eigenvalues $\{\lambda_m\}$ and eigenvectors $\{\mathbf{v}_m\}$. Then, the simple iteration for $\mathbf{r}_k$ can also be written as

$$\mathbf{r}_k = (I - A)^k \mathbf{r}_0 = V(I - \Lambda)^k V^{-1} \mathbf{r}_0 = \sum_{m=1}^n \alpha_m (1 - \lambda_m)^k \mathbf{v}_m$$

This expression contains the *polynomial* $(1 - \lambda_m)^k$ in the eigenvalues of A . The polynomial $(I - A)^k$ of the simple iteration gives convergent iterations only if $\rho(I - A) < 1$. Is it possible to find a polynomial that gives convergence for any A ?

Spectral polynomials of general iterations

A general iteration with some polynomial $P_k(z)$ can be expressed as

$$\mathbf{r}_k = P_k(A)\mathbf{r}_0 = \sum_{m=1}^n \alpha_m P_k(\lambda_m) \mathbf{v}_m$$

Since we want to minimize the residual $\mathbf{r}_k$, such a polynomial should be *minimal on the spectrum of A*.

Transformation of matrices to upper Hessenberg form

Let $Q \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ be a unitary matrix $Q^H Q = I$, where $Q^H = \overline{Q}^T$. For any matrix $A \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ we can write:

$$Q^H A Q = H$$

$$A Q = Q H$$

$$A = Q H Q^H$$

where $H \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ is an upper *Hessenberg* matrix – an almost upper-triangular matrix with zeros below the first sub-diagonal.

Arnoldi algorithm

There is an efficient *Arnoldi* algorithm that allows to build $Q_k \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times k}$ and $H_k \in \mathbb{C}^{k \times k}$ iteratively using the modified Gram-Schmidt process starting with arbitrary vector $\mathbf{b}$:

$$\mathbf{q}_1 = \frac{1}{\|\mathbf{b}\|} \mathbf{b}$$

for $k = 1, 2, \dots$:

$$\mathbf{v} = A\mathbf{q}_k$$

for $j = 1$ to k :

$$h_{j,k} = \mathbf{q}_j^H \mathbf{v}$$

$$\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{v} - h_{j,k} \mathbf{q}_j$$

$$h_{k+1,k} = \|\mathbf{v}\|$$

$$\mathbf{q}_{k+1} = \frac{1}{h_{k+1,k}} \mathbf{v}$$

These iterations produce partial decompositions $AQ_k = Q_{k+1}\tilde{H}_k$, where $\tilde{H}_k \in \mathbb{C}^{(k+1) \times k}$ is H_k with an extra row at the bottom containing all zeros except for the last element $h_{k+1,k}$

Arnoldi algorithm and Krylov subspace

- If Arnoldi algorithm is started with $\mathbf{b}$ from $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$, then the vectors $\{\mathbf{q}_j, j = 1, \dots, k\}$ form an orthonormal basis for the Krylov subspace $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$. In fact, the relation between the Krylov matrix with columns $K_k = [\mathbf{b} \ A\mathbf{b} \ \dots \ A^{k-1}\mathbf{b}]$ and the Arnoldi matrix with columns $Q_k = [\mathbf{q}_1 \ \mathbf{q}_2 \ \dots \ \mathbf{q}_k]$ is the (reduced) QR factorization:

$$K_k = Q_k R_k$$

where R_k is upper-triangular. However, neither K_k nor R_k are formed explicitly by the Arnoldi algorithm, since it would be numerically unstable.

- The matrix $H_k = Q_k^H A Q_k$ is the *orthogonal projection* of A onto $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$. The eigenvalues of H_k are called the *Ritz values* of A with respect to $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$. As $k \rightarrow n$ the Ritz values tend to the eigenvalues of A

Polynomial approximation problem

We are looking for an iterative algorithm that would find an approximation $\mathbf{x}_k$ to the solution of $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ over the Krylov subspace $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}_k &= c_0\mathbf{b} + c_1A\mathbf{b} + c_2A^2\mathbf{b} + \cdots + c_{k-1}A^{k-1}\mathbf{b} \\ \mathbf{x}_k &= P_{k-1}(A)\mathbf{b}\end{aligned}$$

where $P_{k-1}(A)$ is some polynomial defined by its coefficients $\{c_j \mid j = 0, 1, \dots, k-1\}$.

Polynomial approximation problem: Let $\mathcal{P}_k$ be the space of all *monic* polynomials ($c_k = 1$) of degree $\leq k$. We want to find $P_k \in \mathcal{P}_k$ such that

$$\|P_k(A)\mathbf{b}\| = \text{minimum}$$

Arnoldi and polynomial approximation problem

The Arnoldi algorithm solves the polynomial approximation problem

Theorem: *As long as the Arnoldi iteration does not break down (Krylov matrix K_k is of full column rank), the polynomial approximation problem has a unique solution P_k , namely, the characteristic polynomial of H_k*

Proof (1): Since

$$P_k(A)\mathbf{b} = (c_0 + c_1A + \cdots + A^k)\mathbf{b}$$

and the vectors $\{\mathbf{q}_1, \mathbf{q}_2, \dots, \mathbf{q}_k\}$ are the basis for the Krylov subspace spanned by the vectors $\{\mathbf{b}, A\mathbf{b}, \dots, A^{k-1}\mathbf{b}\}$, we can represent any $P_k(A)\mathbf{b}$ as

$$P_k(A)\mathbf{b} = A^k\mathbf{b} - Q_k\mathbf{y}$$

where $\mathbf{y}$ is a vector of unknown coefficients. Hence,

$$\min_{\mathcal{P}_k} \|P_k(A)\mathbf{b}\| \Leftrightarrow \min_{\mathbf{y}} \|A^k\mathbf{b} - Q_k\mathbf{y}\|$$

i.e., the polynomial approximation problem is equivalent to the least-squares (LS) minimization problem and we need to find a point in $\mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$ closest to $A^k\mathbf{b}$.

The residual $P_k(A)\mathbf{b}$ should then satisfy the orthogonality condition

$P_k(A)\mathbf{b} \perp \mathcal{K}^k(A, \mathbf{b})$, or equivalently, $Q_k^H P_k(A)\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{0}$.

Proof (2): The matrices of the exact Hessenberg factorization $A = Q_n H_n Q_n^H$ can be represented in block form as

$$Q_n = [Q_k \quad U], \quad H_n = \begin{bmatrix} H_k & X_1 \\ X_2 & X_3 \end{bmatrix}$$

where Q_k and H_k have been generated by the Arnoldi algorithm, $U \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times (n-k)}$ has orthonormal columns that are also orthogonal to the columns of Q_k , and $X_1 \in \mathbb{C}^{k \times (n-k)}$, $X_2 \in \mathbb{C}^{(n-k) \times k}$, $X_3 \in \mathbb{C}^{(n-k) \times (n-k)}$ are some matrices. Note that all but the upper-right entry of X_2 are equal to zero.

The orthogonality condition can be written as

$$Q_k^H P_k(A) \mathbf{b} = Q_k^H P_k(Q_n H_n Q_n^H) \mathbf{b} = Q_k^H Q_n P_k(H_n) Q_n^H \mathbf{b} = \mathbf{0}$$

By construction all Arnoldi vectors, except for the first one, are orthogonal to $\mathbf{b}$. Hence, only the first entry of the vector $Q_n^H \mathbf{b}$ is nonzero. Therefore, the orthogonality condition demands that the first k entries of the first column of $P_k(H_n)$ are zero. Due to the upper Hessenberg structure of H_n , these are also the upper k entries of the first column of $P_k(H_k)$.

Proof (3): By the *Cayley-Hamilton theorem* (find it!) these entries will be zero if $P_k(H_k)$ is the characteristic polynomial of H_k .

Conversely, suppose there is another polynomial $\tilde{P}_k \in \mathcal{P}_k$ with the property $\tilde{P}_k(A)\mathbf{b} \perp \mathcal{K}_k(A, \mathbf{b})$. Since both P_k and $\tilde{P}_k$ are monial, their difference $R_{k-1} = P_k - \tilde{P}_k$ would be a nonzero polynomial of degree $k - 1$, such that $R_{k-1}(A)\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{0}$. However, if that would be the case, the Krylov matrix K_k would not have a full column rank. $\square$

Minimizing residuals over Krylov subspace

Our goal is to solve the system $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ with nonsingular A . The idea of the Generalized Minimum Residual (GMRES) algorithm is to find $\mathbf{x}_k$ that solves the LS minimization problem over the Krylov subspace:

$$\min_{\mathbf{x}_k \in \mathcal{K}_k(A, \mathbf{b})} \|\mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k\|$$

Since any $\mathbf{x}_k \in \mathcal{K}_k(A, \mathbf{b})$ can be represented as $\mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$, where Q_k has been generated by the Arnoldi algorithm and $AQ_k = Q_{k+1} \tilde{H}_k$, we can also pose this problem as

$$\min_{\mathbf{y}} \|\mathbf{b} - AQ_k \mathbf{y}\|, \quad \mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$$

$$\min_{\mathbf{y}} \|\mathbf{b} - Q_{k+1} \tilde{H}_k \mathbf{y}\|, \quad \mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$$

$$\min_{\mathbf{y}} \|Q_{k+1}^H \mathbf{b} - \tilde{H}_k \mathbf{y}\|, \quad \mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$$

where the last step is permitted since $\mathbf{b} \in \text{Col}(Q_{k+1})$

GMRES algorithm

Finally, we recall that by construction $Q_{k+1}^H \mathbf{b} = \|\mathbf{b}\| \mathbf{e}_1$, where $\mathbf{e}_1 = (1, 0, 0, \dots, 0)^T$ and arrive at the minimization problem at the heart of the GMRES algorithm

$$\min_{\mathbf{y}} \left\| \|\mathbf{b}\| \mathbf{e}_1 - \tilde{H}_k \mathbf{y} \right\|, \quad \mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$$

GMRES:

$$\mathbf{q}_1 = \frac{1}{\|\mathbf{b}\|} \mathbf{b}$$

for $k = 1, 2, \dots$:

step k of Arnoldi algorithm

find $\mathbf{y}$ to minimize $\left\| \|\mathbf{b}\| \mathbf{e}_1 - \tilde{H}_k \mathbf{y} \right\|$

$$\mathbf{x}_k = Q_k \mathbf{y}$$

The inner $(k+1) \times k$ LS problem can be solved by the QR factorization of $\tilde{H}_k$ that can be obtained by updating the QR of $\tilde{H}_{k-1}$ in $\mathcal{O}(k)$ operations

GMRES and polynomial approximation problem

Let $\tilde{\mathcal{P}}_k$ be the space of polynomials $\tilde{P}_k(z)$ of degree $\leq k$ with the property $\tilde{P}_k(0) = 1$. In terms of coefficients we have now $c_0 = 1$ instead of $c_n = 1$.

GMRES iterations produce

$$\mathbf{x}_k = P_{k-1}(A)\mathbf{b}$$

where the coefficients of $P_{k-1}(A)$ are the entries of the vector $\mathbf{c}$, which minimizes $\|\mathbf{b} - AK_k\mathbf{c}\|$, with $K_k\mathbf{c} = Q_kR_k\mathbf{c} = Q_k\mathbf{y}$.

The corresponding residual is

$$\mathbf{r}_k = \mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k = \mathbf{b} - AP_{k-1}(A)\mathbf{b} = (I - AP_{k-1}(A))\mathbf{b} = \tilde{P}_k(A)\mathbf{b}$$

where $\tilde{P}_k(z) = 1 - zP_{k-1}(z) \in \tilde{\mathcal{P}}_k$, since $\tilde{P}_k(0) = 1$. Hence, GMRES solves the following polynomial approximation problem:

$$\min_{\tilde{P}_k \in \tilde{\mathcal{P}}_k} \|\tilde{P}_k(A)\mathbf{b}\|$$

Convergence of GMRES

GMRES will always find the exact solution in n steps. Can it find a good approximation at a step $k < n$? Since $\|\mathbf{r}_k\| = \|\tilde{P}_k(A)\mathbf{b}\| \leq \|\tilde{P}_k(A)\| \|\mathbf{b}\|$, GMRES residuals satisfy

$$\frac{\|\mathbf{r}_k\|}{\|\mathbf{b}\|} \leq \inf_{\tilde{P}_k \in \tilde{\mathcal{P}}_k} \|\tilde{P}_k(A)\|$$

Theorem: Let $A = V\Lambda V^{-1}$ be diagonalizable. At step k of the GMRES algorithm, the residual $\mathbf{r}_k$ satisfies

$$\frac{\|\mathbf{r}_k\|}{\|\mathbf{b}\|} \leq \kappa(V) \inf_{\tilde{P}_k \in \tilde{\mathcal{P}}_k} \|\tilde{P}_k(\Lambda)\|$$

where $\kappa(V) = \|V\| \|V^{-1}\|$ is the condition number of V .

In words: if A is not too far from normal, and if properly normalized degree k polynomials can be found that are small on the spectrum of A , then GMRES converges quickly (e.g. clustered spectra removed from zero - why?)

Other notable Krylov subspace methods

GMRES has the fastest convergence of all Krylov subspace methods, but it may take a lot of memory if it does not converge fast enough, since it requires to store $Q_k \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times k}$. Some alternatives:

- Conjugate Gradient (CG) method: works with symmetric (Hermitian) matrices, short recurrence relation
- Lanczos method: works with symmetric (Hermitian) matrices, based on Arnoldi, three-term recurrence relation, tri-diagonal H_k
- Stabilized Bi-Conjugate Gradient (Bi-CGSTAB): works with any matrix, short recurrence relation, norm of the residual does not reduce monotonically
- Restarted GMRES(m): saves space by restarting Arnoldi iterations after m steps, stores only $Q_m \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times m}$, convergence is slower though

Preconditioning

Instead of solving $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ we could also solve

$$M^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = M^{-1}\mathbf{b}$$

where M is any nonsingular matrix. If M^{-1} is not available, this may require solving systems of the form $M\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{c}$ at each step of an iterative algorithm.

Matrix M is called *preconditioner*. If well chosen, it may significantly accelerate convergence of an iterative algorithm

Common preconditioners

- *Diagonal scaling or Jacobi:* $M = \text{diag}(A)$ or $M = \text{diag}(\mathbf{c})$
- *ILU:* $M = \tilde{L}\tilde{U}$, where $\tilde{L}$ and $\tilde{U}$ are triangular and sparse (M^{-1} is easy to compute), and approximate the exact LU factors of A
- *Coarse-grid approximation:* $M = \langle \text{to fine grid} \rangle \circ \tilde{A} \circ \langle \text{to coarse grid} \rangle$, $\tilde{A}$ is a coarse-grid discretization of the operator, small matrix
- *Geometric and algebraic multigrid:* iterated application of coarse- and fine-grid discretizations or judicious 'grouping' of matrix elements
- *Block preconditioners, domain decomposition, low-order discretization, constant coefficient and symmetric approximations, matrix splitting, single step of classical iterations, convolution approximation (FFT), polynomial preconditioners, deflation, shifted Laplacian*